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My Own Teaching Philosophy

Instructions:

1. Write your **own** teaching philosophy statement. This should not be quoted directly from any of the philosophies discussed in class rather use them as reference in coming up with your own.
2. Analyze your philosophy statement based on: aim of education, teaching-learning process, and methods of teaching.
3. Draw conclusion based on your answers to 1 & 2.

I. Teaching Philosophy Statement

I believe that education exists to help each person discover who they truly are and, in that discovery, find the courage and the reason to make the world more just. My teaching philosophy leans toward existentialism and social reconstructionism because both have been written into my own life. I grew up with very little, and I learned early that a young person's future should never be decided by the size of their family's income or the distance of their home from the city. What changed the direction of my life was not wealth but knowledge, freely and generously shared by people who chose to believe in me before I could believe in myself.

This is why the question of equity sits at the very center of my philosophy. A learner in an under-resourced public school or in a far-flung barangay is not less capable than a learner surrounded by tutors, devices, and every advantage money can buy. They are simply given less. I have come to believe that a genius or a gifted soul does not get to choose where it sprouts. Brilliant and curious children are scattered everywhere, in the mountains, in the fishing villages, and in the crowded classrooms of ordinary towns, regardless of their family's social status or surroundings. What too often decides their fate is not talent but opportunity. I see teachers as the instruments who must find these great minds wherever they are and help them flourish, not only for their own sake but so that their gifts may one day serve the betterment of society.

At the same time, I want my teaching to nurture something I feel is quietly fading in this age of technology and relentless competition, which is self-awareness backed by humility and genuine compassion. It is easy today to chase achievement while forgetting how to be human with one another. I, therefore, hope to form learners who pursue excellence and self-realization without losing their kindness, who know themselves deeply and yet remain humble, and who understand that a life well lived is a life lived meaningfully alongside others. Nevertheless, even here, I remain aware of a line I must not cross. I do not wish to hand my students ready-made conclusions or shape them in my own image, but rather to place honest questions before them and trust them to decide what to believe and how to act, because a conviction imposed from the outside can never truly become their own.

II. Analysis (in terms of):

A. Aim

When I look honestly at my own statement, I find that my central aim holds up well, because it asks education to form the individual and, through that individual, to help reform society. What I value most about it is that it refuses to separate the personal from the social. I do not ask students to find themselves or to serve others as if these were rival paths, since I treat self-discovery as the very thing that leads a person outward toward others. My aim is reasonable too, for I never claim that schooling will fix society, only that it can free people and prepare them to contribute. It also feels authentic to me rather than borrowed, having grown out of my own life instead of a textbook. Even so, the weaknesses are real, and I cannot pretend otherwise. I assume that a learner's freedom to define themselves will always point toward the social good, yet that outcome is never guaranteed, and a student might genuinely choose a quiet and private life instead. Placing nearly the entire burden on the teacher is another strain, because finding and lifting hidden talent is a noble task, but a single teacher alone cannot outmuscle poverty and lack of funding. My statement also speaks a great deal about characters I value such as humility and compassion while saying far less about intellectual mastery and academic rigor as goals that deserve to be pursued for their own sake.

These tensions, I believe, can be reconciled, however, without abandoning what I hold dear. Rather than demanding that every learner turn their freedom toward justice, I can offer that path as an invitation, trusting that self-aware students will lean toward compassion on their own.

B. Teaching-Learning Process

If my philosophy is going to mean anything, it has to survive contact with an actual classroom, so it helps to think through the moments where it will be tested. For example, I may have a learner who never recites, not because the lesson is beyond her, but because years of being overlooked in a large public school class have taught her that speaking up changes nothing. My existentialist commitment to helping each person find their own voice faces its first real test here, since I would need to build enough trust for her to risk giving the wrong answer in front of her classmates. Other situations test the social reconstructionist side of how I want learning to unfold. In addition to those individual struggles, a lesson might naturally connect to a real problem the students already know, such as flooding in a low-lying community, farmers who cannot sell at fair prices, or families forced apart by overseas work. When that happens, my role is not to hand them a verdict but to lay the issue before them and guide them as they weigh different sides and reach their own conclusions, which is where meaningful learning tends to take root. There will also be harder days, such as when a group task falls apart because the confident students take over while the shy ones withdraw, and rather than smoothing it over, I would treat that breakdown as material for a lesson on listening and shared responsibility.

Here I have to add an important reminder to myself, because there is a fine line between opening minds and steering them. While I want my students to develop a deeper sense of who they are and a real awareness of their responsibility to others, I must be careful never to push them toward my own conclusions or turn my classroom into a place of indoctrination. My task is to present the problems honestly, to encourage discernment, and to let them decide for themselves whether and how to act, since a freedom that is dictated is no freedom at all. Holding this balance is both the promise and the difficulty of my approach.

C. Methods

My methods have to be simple, low-cost, and doable in ordinary Philippine classrooms. That matters because I may face forty or fifty students with very few materials, so my strategies cannot depend on resources that are not there. On the existentialist side, one of the easiest strategies I can use is reflective journal writing, where students spend the last five minutes of class writing about what a lesson meant to them or how it connects to their own lives. In addition, I can use think-pair-share, which lets a quiet student first gather their thoughts, then test them with one seatmate before facing the whole room. This works well in overpopulated classes precisely because it turns a large crowd into many small, manageable conversations without needing any equipment. Oral storytelling and interviews also let learners draw on the knowledge of their families and communities, so a lesson on history or economics can begin with a grandparent's account or a neighbor's livelihood rather than an expensive textbook. Another low-cost method is peer teaching, where students who grasp a concept explain it to those who are struggling, which stretches thin resources further while quietly building confidence in both. On the social reconstructionist side, my methods can turn real community problems into learning material without any budget. A simple community-based activity might ask students to observe an issue in their own barangay, such as improper waste disposal or unsafe roads, and then discuss possible responses in class, which roots their learning in genuine civic life. Structured debates and problem-solving discussions around local concerns cost nothing but encourage them to weigh evidence, listen to opposing views, and think independently before deciding where they stand.

III. Conclusion

When I put the pieces together, my belief is that education should help a person understand who they are while also waking them up to the people around them. My aims give that belief a direction, my teaching-learning process gives it a place to happen, and my methods make it survive in real classrooms with real limits. What ties everything together is that I do not want teaching to be the simple passing of facts. I want it to be a way of recognizing each learner as someone with a mind worth freeing and a community worth caring about.

I also know that saying all this is easy and living it will be much harder, since thin budget and daily teacher and student fatigue have a way of wearing ideals down. I do not expect to get it right every time, and I have tried to be honest about the places where my beliefs rub against reality or risk going too far. I also expect this philosophy to keep changing as I actually teach, because experience has a way of correcting the things we are sure about too early. Even so, I would rather commit to something worth reaching for than settle for nothing at all.

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